

What counts as investment?

Distinguish investment from speculation and saving by the main source of payoff or priority. / 根据主要回报来源或优先事项，区分投资、投机和储蓄。

Three complete definitions / 三个完整定义

Investment 投资	Investment is committing money to an asset because its income , productive use or evidence-supported change in underlying value is expected to generate a return, while accepting possible loss. 投资是把资金投入资产，因为预期其收入、生产性用途或有证据支持的内在价值变化能够带来回报，同时接受可能发生损失。
Speculation 投机	Speculation is seeking profit mainly from a predicted price movement or uncertain event; the payoff depends mainly on the prediction being correct. 投机是主要从预测的价格变动或不确定事件中寻求利润；回报主要取决于预测是否正确。
Saving 储蓄	Saving is keeping money mainly for future use, prioritising safety and ready access over a higher expected return. 储蓄是把钱主要留作未来使用，优先考虑安全性和随时取用，而不是追求较高的预期回报。

Classify by the main clue / 根据主要线索分类

If the main clue is... 如果主要线索是.....	Classify as 应归为
Income, productive activity or evidence-supported underlying value. 收入、生产性活动或有证据支持的内在价值。	Investment 投资
A predicted price movement or uncertain event. 预测的价格变动或不确定事件。	Speculation - not investment 投机 - 不是投资
Safety and ready access take priority. 安全性和随时取用优先。	Saving - not investment 储蓄 - 不是投资

Do not decide from these alone: product name, future goal, risk level or time horizon. / 不要只凭以下因素判断：产品名称、未来目标、风险水平或持有期限。

Investment or speculation?

Compare the expected source of payoff; do not decide from the product or risk alone. /
比较预期回报的来源；不要只凭产品或风险作判断。

Core comparison / 核心比较

Criterion 判断维度	Investment 投资	Speculation 投机
Main source of payoff 主要回报来源	Income, productive activity or evidence-supported growth in underlying value. 收入、生产性活动或有证据支持的内在价值增长。	A predicted price movement or uncertain event. 预测的价格变动或不确定事件。
Decision basis 决策依据	Evidence about cash flows, earnings, value and diversification. 关于现金流、盈利、价值和分散化的证据。	Price forecast or timing dominates; rumours, borrowing or urgency may matter. 价格预测或时机占主导；传闻、借款或紧迫性可能很重要。
Role of resale 转售的作用	Resale may matter, but it is not the only basis for expected return. 转售可能重要，但不是预期回报的唯一依据。	Profit depends mainly on selling after a favourable price move. 获利主要依赖在有利的价格变动后卖出。
Risk and horizon 风险与期限	May be risky and may be short or long term. 可能有风险，也可能是短期或长期。	Often highly uncertain or short term, but those clues alone do not define it. 往往不确定性较高或期限较短，但这些线索本身不能作定义。
Same product? 相同产品？	Shares, property or gold can be used for investment. 股票、房产或黄金可用于投资。	The same assets can be used for speculation. 同样的资产也可用于投机。

Underline the decisive clause, then classify / 在决定性语句下划线并分类

Decision 决定	Classify 分类
Nora studies a company's earnings and cash flows, then buys a diversified group of shares to participate in the businesses' future returns. 诺拉研究一家公司的盈利和现金流，然后买入一组分散化股票，以分享这些企业未来的回报。	WORKED EXAMPLE Investment
Omar borrows money to buy the same shares after a social-media rumour predicts a price jump next week. He plans to sell immediately after the rise. 奥马尔听到社交媒体传闻称同一批股票下周会涨价，于是借款买入，并计划上涨后立即卖出。	Category + decisive clue 类别 + 决定性线索
Pia buys an apartment after estimating rent, maintenance and vacancy costs. She expects rent to be the main source of return. 皮娅估算租金、维修费和空置成本后买入一套公寓，并预期租金将是主要回报来源。	Category + decisive clue 类别 + 决定性线索

Investment or saving?

Compare the main purpose: seeking return or preserving money for use. /
比较主要目的：寻求回报，还是为使用而保留资金。

Core comparison / 核心比较

Criterion 判断维度	Investment 投资	Saving 储蓄
Main purpose 主要目的	Seek a financial return from an asset. 从资产中寻求财务回报。	Preserve money for future use. 为未来使用保留资金。
Possible loss 可能损失	Accept that the asset's value may fall. 接受资产价值可能下跌。	Prioritise safety of the money kept. 优先保障所保存资金的安全。
Access 取用	May accept price fluctuation or limited access. 可能接受价格波动或取用受限。	Ready access is often important. 随时取用通常很重要。
Expected payoff 预期回报	Income or growth is uncertain; a higher return is sought. 收入或增长具有不确定性；寻求较高回报。	Interest may be modest; earning interest alone does not make it investment. 利息可能较低；仅仅获得利息并不会使其成为投资。
Future goal 未来目标	Can fund a future goal when return and risk are suitable. 在回报和风险合适时可用于未来目标。	Can also fund a future goal; the goal alone does not decide. 也可用于未来目标；目标本身不能决定类别。

Same future goal, different decision / 相同的未来目标，不同的决定

Decision 决定	Classify 分类
Qin keeps next year's emergency medical money in an easy-access account and accepts the low return because safety matters most. 秦把明年的应急医疗资金存入可随时取用的账户，并接受较低回报，因为安全性最重要。	WORKED EXAMPLE <i>Saving</i>
Ravi prepares for a university payment in twelve years by buying a diversified fund after reading its fees and risks. He accepts that its value may fall. 拉维为十二年后的大学费用购买分散化基金；他阅读费用和风险说明，并接受基金价值可能下跌。	Category + decisive clue 类别 + 决定性线索
Sara needs a house deposit in six months, so she keeps the money in a protected bank account that allows quick withdrawal. 萨拉六个月后需要支付购房首付款，因此把钱存在可快速取用的受保护银行账户中。	Category + decisive clue 类别 + 决定性线索
Tom uses a diversified share fund for retirement in twenty-five years. He compares costs and accepts that prices will sometimes fall. 汤姆为二十五年后的退休购买分散化股票基金；他比较成本，并接受价格有时会下跌。	Category + decisive clue 类别 + 决定性线索

Use the decision rule

Ask the questions in order. If evidence is insufficient, do not force a category. /
按顺序提问；证据不足时不要勉强分类。

Step 步骤	Ask 提问	If yes 如果是
1	Is safety and ready access the main priority? 安全性和随时取用是否最重要？	Saving 储蓄
2	If return is the goal, is it expected mainly from income, productive activity or evidence-supported underlying value? 若目标是回报，是否主要来自收入、生产性活动或有证据支持的内在价值？	Investment 投资
3	Does payoff depend mainly on a predicted price movement or uncertain event? 回报是否主要依赖预测的价格变动或不确定事件？	Speculation 投机

Correct each inaccurate claim / 改正每个不准确的说法

Inaccurate claim 不准确的说法	More accurate correction 更准确的改正
It is for a future goal, so it is an investment. 它用于未来目标，所以它是投资。	
It uses shares, so it is an investment. 它涉及股票，所以它是投资。	
It is risky and short term, so it must be speculation. 它风险高且期限短，所以一定是投机。	

MCQs / 选择题

1. Which factor most clearly distinguishes investment from speculation?

- A. The name of the asset.
- B. Whether any risk exists.
- C. The main expected source of payoff.
- D. Whether the goal is in the future.

2. Which decision is saving rather than investment?

- A. Keeping next year's tuition in a protected, easy-access account.
- B. Buying a diversified fund for twenty years while accepting possible loss.
- C. Buying shares after analysing earnings and cash flows.
- D. Buying an apartment mainly for expected rental income.

3. Which is the clearest evidence of speculation rather than investment?

- A. Expected rental income after analysing costs.
- B. A diversified portfolio supported by business evidence.
- C. Borrowing after a rumour of a next-week price jump and planning an immediate sale.
- D. Accepting that a long-term fund may sometimes fall in value.